

# Mastering Terraform Basics for Cloud Beginners

Terraform lets you build cloud infrastructure using simple text files instead of clicking through web consoles. Learning this skill saves you hours of manual work and makes you a much faster cloud engineer.

### What you'll learn:

1. Writing Your First Configuration File
2. Initializing Your Workspace
3. Previewing Your Changes
4. Applying and Cleaning Up

### Aman Raj Singh

Cloud Operations Engineer @ iManage

[linkedin.com/in/mramanrajsingh](https://linkedin.com/in/mramanrajsingh)

# 1

TIP 1 OF 4

## 1. Writing Your First Configuration File

Instead of clicking buttons in the AWS console, you write a simple text file ending in .tf. This file tells Terraform exactly what cloud resources you want to create, such as a virtual machine or a storage bucket. You can easily share this file with your teammates so everyone builds the exact same setup.

```
$resource "aws_instance" "my_server" {  
  ami           = "ami-0c55b159cbfafa1f0"  
  instance_type = "t2.micro"  
}
```

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# 2

TIP 2 OF 4

## 2. Initializing Your Workspace

Before Terraform can build anything, it needs to download the right translator plugins for your cloud provider like AWS, Azure, or Google Cloud. The init command looks at your code, figures out what plugins you need, and downloads them right into your project folder automatically.

```
$ terraform init
```

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# 3

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## 3. Previewing Your Changes

Never rush into building cloud infrastructure blindly. The plan command acts like a safety net, reading your configuration and showing you a neat preview of what will be added, changed, or deleted. It helps you catch silly mistakes before they affect your live systems.

```
$terraform plan
```

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# 4

TIP 4 OF 4

## 4. Applying and Cleaning Up

Once you are happy with your preview, the apply command builds your actual cloud resources. When you are completely done testing and want to avoid surprise cloud bills, the destroy command neatly packs up and deletes everything you built.

```
$ terraform apply
# Later, when you are done:
terraform destroy
```

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## Key Takeaways

- + Always run terraform plan before running terraform apply.
- + Keep your infrastructure code organized in small, manageable folders.
- + Use version control like Git to track changes to your configuration files.
- + Never store secret passwords or access keys directly inside your code files.
- + Name your resources clearly so your team knows what they do.

## Watch Out For

- ! Forgetting to run terraform init before trying to plan or apply.
- ! Modifying cloud resources manually in the web console after creating them with Terraform.
- ! Leaving test infrastructure running overnight and getting unexpected bills.

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